

ROYAL ARCH SCRIPTURE

Scripture from the ritual of the Degrees
contained in the Chapter of Royal Arch Masons.

Notes for use:

This work is not just prayers contained in the Chapter ritual, but a reference to any, and all scripture quoted in the ritual contained within the Chapter Royal Arch Masons Standard Works.

I discovered the source of all passages from an online link:

<https://www.kingjamesbibleonline.org/search.php>

Read the listed Scripture from the KJV in its entirety, then read the helps for each verse.

I have researched all of the Scripture in the ritual I could find and referenced the many of the helps I found in the KJV Study Bible.

For a more complete reading of the Helps please refer to the KJV Study Bible itself.

Occasionally the introduction to the Book of Scripture is quoted from the KJV Study Bible. It is highly recommended that each introduction is read in turn. In addition to looking up the scripture, once I had discovered the source chapter and verse, I used my KJV Study Guide Bible to give context to each passage.

In addition, my KJV Study Guide Bible has a forward to each Chapter giving details about the author , a time table of when it was written and I frequently added that info to the document as well.

It is my hope that all Royal Arch Masons will dig deeper into their ritual and discover as I did the fuller meaning of our most important part of our ritual...the Holy Scriptures.

Companion John Howard McCurdy, PHP
Excellent High Priest
Price Chapter No. 6, RAM of Utah

Mark Master

Opening: Charge

So now then, let us proceed to the opening Charge of a Mark Master Degree;
All Scripture readings are from the King James Version (KJV).

“Ye also as living stones, be ye built up a spiritual house, an holy priesthood, to offer up sacrifices acceptable to God. **1 Peter 2:5**

Helps:

The author of this epistle was Simon Peter; the well-known and beloved disciple of Christ. Peter is believed to have died in AD 67 in the persecutions of Nero. His main theme is: Hope through Christ in the midst of suffering.

The Church: To the body of those who belong to the Lord, to their assemblies , and the places where they meet.

“The people of God are the Temple of God.”

Also: **Psalms 118 :22**; “The stone which the builders refused is become the headstone of the corner.” This is a reference to Christ, rejected by the leaders of Israel but exalted by God into the cornerstone as the foundation of his spiritual building.

The Psalms: Hebrew sacred song really began with Israel’s Birth as a nation, and it then continued for more than one thousand years. The earliest recorded composer of Psalms was Moses. His first was a solemn choral song with musical accompaniment sung after the crossing of the Red Sea.

See also: 1 Cor. 3:11. “For other foundation can no man lay than is laid, which is Jesus Christ.”

Also: 2 Cor. 6:16 “for ye are the temple of the living God; as God hath said, I will dwell in them, and walk in them; and I will be their God. And they shall be my people.”

1 Corinthians was written by the Apostle Paul.

Paul wrote the letter while at Ephesus before the celebration of Pentecost. He planted the Church in Corinth in AD 51.

He began preaching in the synagogue every Sabbath and after opposition from the Jews he turned his focus to preaching the Gospel to the Gentiles. (mostly Greeks)

2 Corinthians was also written by the Apostle Paul, writing from Macedonia about one year after writing 1 Cor.

The main theme is: The nature of new covenant ministry by the power of the Spirit, with present suffering and for future glory.

This is a book to which not only gospel ministers, but all Christians, can go to find encouragement and perspective in the midst of the difficulties of criticism, inadequacy and insufficiency.

“Wherefore, also, it is contained in the Scripture: ‘ Behold I lay in Zion, for a foundation, a tried stone, a precious cornerstone, a sure foundation; he that believeth shall not make haste to pass over ‘; ‘Unto you, therefore, which believe, it is an honor; and even to them which is disobedient, the stone which the builders disallowed, the same is made the head of the corner’. .” **Isaiah 28:16**

Helps:

Isaiah, whose name means ‘Jehovah is salvation’ is the sole author of the prophecy that bears his name.

His main theme is Judgment for sin and salvation by grace in the coming Messiah for the glory of God.

Isaiah makes clear both who the Messiah will be and what he will do in order to accomplish redemption.

The narratives of the four gospels are no more vivid in detailing the history of Christ’s death and resurrection than Isaiah’s prediction (**53:1-12**) which is recommended as reading for all.

The Hebrew implies a past action; the Lord has already established Christ as the basis of the covenant of grace.

The verbal form indicates constant habitual believing. Not yield or hurry away. True faith perseveres.

In fact, Isaiah teaches us that we cannot separate the three realities of Salvation, judgment and the glory of God. Even the Servant Himself must fall under divine judgment if he will save his people from their sins.

“Brethren this is the will of God, that with well-doing ye put to silence the ignorance of foolish men. As free, and not using your liberty for a cloak of maliciousness, but as the servants of God. Honor all men; love the brotherhood; fear God.” **I Peter 2:17**

Mark Master

Second Section

“Then he brought me back by way of the gate of the outward sanctuary which looketh toward the East, and it was shut”. **Ezekiel 44:1**

“Then said the Lord unto me, this gate shall be shut; it shall not be opened, and no man shall enter in by it; because the Lord, the God of Israel, hath entered in by it, therefore it shall be shut.”

“It is for the Prince, the Prince, he shall sit in it to eat bread before the Lord: he shall enter by way of the porch of that gate, and shall go out by the way of the same”. **Ezekiel 44:3**

“And the Lord said unto me, Son of Man mark well, and behold with thine eyes, and hear with thine ears, all that I say unto thee, concerning all the ordinances of the House of the Lord, and all the laws thereof; and mark well, with the entering in of the house, with every going forth of the Sanctuary.”

Ezekiel 44:5

Helps:

Ezekiel means “God Strengthens” and he served God as both an ordained priest and a prophet.

Theme: Destruction and restoration for the sake of God’s holiness and glory.

Date: Ezekiel was 25 years old when he was taken captive and brought to Babylon. His ministry continued until the 27th year of the captivity, a ministry extending from 592 to 570 BC.

“For the kingdom of heaven is like unto a man that is an householder, which went out early in the morning to hire laborers into his vineyard. And when he had agreed with the laborers for a penny a day, he sent them into his vineyard. And he went out about the third hour, and saw others standing idle in the market place, and said unto them: Go ye also into the vineyard, and whatsoever is right, I will give you. And they went their way. Again he went out about the sixth and ninth hour, and did likewise. And about the eleventh hour he went out and found other standing idle, and saith unto them: Why stand ye here all the day idle? They say unto him: Because no man hath hired us. He saith unto them: Go ye also into the vineyard, and whatsoever is right, that shall ye receive. So when even was come, the lord of the vineyard saith unto his steward: Call the laborers and give them their hire, beginning from the last unto the first. And when they came that were hired about the eleventh hour, they received every man a penny. But when the first came, they supposed that they should have received more; and they likewise received every man a penny; and when they had received it, they murmured against the good man of the house, saying: These last have wrought but one hour and thou hast made them equal unto us, which have borne the burden and the heat of the day. But he answered one of them and said: Friend, I do thee no wrong; didst thou not agree with me for a penny? Take that thine is and go unto thee. Is it not lawful for me to do what I will with mine own? Is thine eye evil because I am good? So, the last shall be first and the first last; for many be called, but few chosen.”

Mat 20:1 – 16

Helps:

Eye evil; an idiom for greed. The selfish and self-righteous take offence at God's grace to the undeserving.

The last shall be first and the first last; In God's kingdom of grace, we must not presume that we are superior to others.

Matthew: He was also known as Levi and was a tax collector before Jesus called him to be a disciple.

Date: The early church dates Matthew to the time when both Peter and Paul were in Rome, thus early 60's.

Theme: Jesus is both Christ and Emmanuel fulfilling the ancient promise and bringing God's reign to earth through his life, death, and resurrection.

Also, as the Lord's anointed, Jesus is also Emmanuel, that is, "God with us".

"To him that overcometh will I give to eat of the hidden manna, and I will give him a white stone, and in the stone a new name written which no man knoweth, saving him that receiveth it" . **Revelation 2:17**

Helps:

The hidden manna is Christ, the heavenly food of believers.

The white stone a verdict of innocence.

A new name; a new identity in God's love and glory coming from an intimate knowledge of God reserved only for the redeemed.

Names written on things signify identity, ownership, and spiritual oneness.

PAST MASTER

Opening charge:

“Blessed is the man that walketh not in the council of the ungodly, nor standeth in the way of sinners nor sitteth in the seat of the scornful.....” **Psalms 1:1-6**

Helps:

The period in which the book of Psalms was written must have been approximately from 1445 BC (the probable date of the exodus) to 444 BC (when the work on Jerusalem’s walls was completed), a period of one thousand years.

Charge at closing

“Lord, who shall abide in thy Tabernacle? Who shall dwell in thy holy hill?
He that walketh uprightly, and worketh righteousness and speaketh the truth in his heart.....he that doeth these things shall never be moved.”

Helps:

Psalms 15:1-5; A Psalm of David.

Vers 5; usury; interest on loans a crime in ancient Israel.

MOST EXCELLENT MASTER

Opening at alter

“The earth is the Lord’s and the fullness thereof and they that dwell thereof; the world, and they that dwell therein.....Who is this King of Glory? The Lord of hosts, He is the King of Glory”

Psalm 24:1-10

Helps:

Lift up gates...doors, addressed to the Levites who guarded the entrances into the Temple, or a type of the angels guarding the gates of heaven.

First Section

Work:

- 1.)- “I was glad when they said unto me, let us go into the house of the Lord.”
- 2.)- “Our feet shall stand within thy gates, O Jerusalem.”
- 3.)- “Jerusalem is builded as a city that is compact together:”
- 4.)- Whither the tribes go up, the tribes of the Lord, unto the Testimony of Israel, to give thanks unto the name of the Lord.”
- 5.)- “For there are set thrones of judgment, the thrones of the house of David.”
- 6.)- “Pray for the peace of Jerusalem; they shall prosper that love thee. “
- 7.)- “Peace be within thy walls, and prosperity within thy palaces.”
- 8.)- “For my brethren and companions’ sake, I will now say, Peace be within thee. Because of the house of the Lord our God I will seek thy good.”

Psalms 122:1-9

Helps: A Song of degrees of David.

In David’s day the tabernacle, which was replaced by Solomon’s Temple, Gods dwelling place.”

Verse 3: the unity of the various tribes when they worshiped together.

Verse 4: the testimony of Israel...the Arc of the Covenant.

The totality of God’s perfection that he has reveled.

Second Section

Prayer

O Lord God of Israel, there is no God like thee in heaven nor in the earth....

And hearken thou to the supplications of thy servant and of thy people Israel when they shall pray toward this place.....

1 Kings 8:23 – 30.

Helps:

8:23 mercy. Covenant love and loyalty

8:26 be verified Prove to be firm and reliable. The Hebrew word is the basis of ‘Amen’

8:27 God is both in all places and beyond all places...infinite with regard to space. This makes it all the more remarkable that he would manifest his presence in the Temple.

A central function of the Temple was to offer access to God through prayer.

Access to the Father comes through Christ by a spirit –worked faith.

“Now therefore, arise, O Lord God, into thy resting place, thou, and the arc of thy strength **Psalms 132:8-10**

Helps:

132:8 A request for God’s presence to dwell in the Temple

132:9 Those who are recipients of covenant love and thus Holy.

132:10 anointed. Gods appointed King (literally messiah)

Dedication of the Temple: “For he is good; for his mercy endureth forever...

2 Chron 7:1-3

Helps:

Authorship, The traditional belief of rabbinical Judaism and medieval Christianity has been that Chronicles were a single work written by Ezra the scribe.

Date: before or during the ministry of Ezra in Judah. In 586 BC the Babylonian army conquered Judah. The northern tribes were exiled around 721 BC.

The exile of Judah continued for about seventy years. Around 538 BC Cyrus, king of Persia issued a decree that the exiled people could return to their land and rebuild the Temple. It is into this frame of reference that Chronicles 1 & 2 were written.

Theme: God acts in history from Adam through the son of David to build a kingdom of true worship from the heart.

ROYAL ARCH MASON

First Section

P.S.: “I will bring the blind by a way they know not; I will lead them in paths they have not known ; I will make darkness light before them, and crooked things straight. These things I will do unto them, and not forsake them.”

Isaiah 42:16

Now Moses kept the flock of Jethro his father –in law, the priest of Midian: and he led the flock to the back side of the desert, and came to the mountain of God, even to Horeb.

And the angel of the LORD appeared unto him in a flame of fire out of the midst of a bush.....

“Moreover he said, I *am* the God of thy father, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob. And Moses hid his face; for he was afraid to look upon God.” Exodus 3:1-14

First Prayer;

I cried unto the Lord with my voice; with my voice did I make my supplication.... Psalm 142:1-7

Helps:

Psalm 142-5

When our friends fail us the believer may rest in knowing that the Lord is all the protection and provision that he needs.

Second Prayer;

Hear my prayer O my Lord; give ear to my supplication; in thy faithfulness answer me, and in thy righteousness.....Thy mercy cut off mine enemies for I am thy servant.” Amen Palms 143:1-12

Helps:

Psalms 143:2

If God judged us by our works or personal worthiness according to the rigor of his law, then he would declare no one righteous.

Second Section

And the Lord said unto him, what is that in your hand? And he said a rod. And he said, cast it on the ground. **Exodus 4:1-4**

And the Lord said furthermore unto him, Put now thy hand into thy bosom. And he put his hand into his bosom, and when he took it out, behold, his hand was leprous as snow. **Exodus 4:8,9**

Jeshua: O Zerubbabel in the rebuilding of the house: “ This is the word of the Lord unto Zerubbabel saying Not by might, nor by power, but by my spirit.....” **Zechariah 4:6**

Moreover, the word of the Lord came unto me saying: The hands of Zerubbabel have laid the foundation...**Zechariah 4:8-10**

Jeshua; In that day will I raise up the tabernacle of David that is fallen....**Amos 9:11**

Jeshua: In the beginning God created heaven and earth...**Genesis 1:1-3**

Jeshua; And it came to pass when Moses had made an end of writing the words of his law in a book....**Deuteronomy 31:24 – 26**

Jeshua reading: And thou shall put the mercy seat above upon the ark...**Exodus 26:34**

Jeshua reading: This is the thing which the Lord commandeth: Fill an omer of it to be kept for your generations.... **Exodus 16:32-34**

Jeshua reading: And the Lord said unto Moses: bring Aaron’s rod again before the testimony to be kept as a token. **Numbers 17:10**

Jeshua: And God spake unto Moses and said unto him, I am the Lord, and I appeared unto Abraham, unto Isaac and unto Jacob.... But by my name Jehovah was I not known to them. **Exodus 6:2**